LOUIEWOOD: From Gingoog Dirt to GLOBAL DYNASTY

Written By: Francis Louie Caingles Ramoso

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"From Hood to Hollywood: One Man's War Against the Odds"

Dedication

To the ones still stuck in the fire.
To the daughters I burn for.
To the future I refused to lose.

Epigraph

"They tried to bury me.
They didn't know I was the
seed."

Introduction: “This Ain’t a Fairytale”

This book ain’t for everyone.

It’s for the ones who had to grow up before they were ready.
The ones who know what it’s like to count coins for rice.
The ones who had to break rules just to survive a system that never gave 'em a rulebook.

My name is Francis Louie.
This is my story — raw, unfiltered, and still unfolding.

From barefoot chases through banana fields to building something real in Gingoog, I didn’t write this to inspire likes. I wrote this so no one else has to learn the hard way like I did. This book ain’t just a memoir — it’s a blueprint. For hustlers. For fathers. For fighters.

If you're reading this, you probably already know how cold the streets can get. But I need you to know one thing:
We can make fire out of that cold. We can build out of the burn.

So turn the page.
Walk through my past.
And maybe, just maybe, you’ll find your way out of yours.

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Author's Note

I almost didn't write this.
Too many ghosts. Too much shame. Too much fear that telling the truth would bring everything crashing down again.

But silence never saved anyone. And someone out there needs this more than I need my comfort.

I'm not a saint. I'm not a CEO in a suit. I'm just a man who refused to stay buried.

So I wrote this for the next me.
The kid who's staring at a bike he can't afford.
The father who doesn't know how to show up.
The hustler who knows there's gotta be more than just dodging bullets and building walls.

This book is proof.
That you can start with nothing.
And build everything.

If you make it to the last page?
You'll know exactly why the world started calling it…
Louiewood.

Chapter 1: Broken Beginnings

Gingoog City wasn't the kind of place people pointed to on a map and said, ***"That's where greatness begins."*** But for Francis Louie, it was home, a place where rusted tricycles lined the streets, the scent of sizzling carinderia meat hung in the air, and dreams felt more like whispers tossed into the wind.

If comfort was a country, he'd never crossed the border. He came from cracked floors, unfinished ceilings, and nights when the rumbling of an empty stomach drowned out the lullabies his mother once sang. Life in Northern Mindanao had its beauty, the sea kissing the shorelines, mountains standing tall in the distance, but beauty doesn't feed you. It doesn't pay bills. And it doesn't give you a second chance.



By the time Francis hit his mid-20s, it felt like he'd already lived a dozen lifetimes. He'd

become a father twice, to two daughters, born from two women who had once believed in him, even when he didn't believe in himself. Love was complicated, but fatherhood? That was real. It gave his life purpose. But direction meant nothing when you didn't have the means to move forward.

He hustled where he could — flipping second hand bike parts on Facebook, reselling cheap phone accessories from Shopee, even designing tricycle logos on his cracked Android. When his phone couldn't keep up, he'd walk to the nearest pisonet café, rent time by the peso, and grind online — anything to keep the hustle alive. Just enough to survive. Not enough to live. Every peso counted. Every dream had to wait.

One night, under a sky heavy with stars and doubt, Francis sat outside his small rented room, smoking a cheap cigarette. ***There's got to be more to life than this***. Not more luxury. Not fame. Just more ***possibilities***. A way to break free from the invisible prison of poverty.

Then came the idea. The kind of idea most people would dismiss out of fear.

Marijuana.

He'd seen it around. Smelled it in alleyways. Heard stories of people making big money, fast, but dangerous. Something about it lingered in his mind. Not because he wanted to be a criminal. Not because of the thrill. But because it was the one opportunity nobody else seemed willing to chase. Where others saw risk, he saw a chance.

What if this was the way?

But this wasn't a movie. This was real life. And in real life, people get caught. They go to jail. Or worse. In the Philippines, drug laws weren't just strict, they were deadly.

Francis knew that. And yet, he couldn't shake the thought. Not because he didn't care, but because he had no other choice. No capital for a business. No degree. No connections. Just guts. Guilt. And grit.

That night, he didn't make a decision.

But the seed was planted.

And as all seeds do, with time, pain, and care, it began to grow.

Chapter 2: A Dream in the Smoke

The next morning came like every other. Same cracked walls. Same pan de sal with coffee. Same noise from the tricycles echoing down the road. But something inside Francis had changed. That seed, that crazy idea, had taken root in his chest. And now, it was growing wild.



He looked at his daughters' photos taped to the wall, torn from an old wallet. Their smiles were pure. Innocent. They had no idea how hard the world was. And he was determined to keep it that way, to give them a life where their shoes didn't have holes and their birthdays didn't pass without cake.

The weed game wasn't new to the streets. He'd known guys from the barangay who sold joints out of plastic sachets and made quick money. But they were sloppy, loud about their hustle, flashy with their cash. Most of them didn't last long. Either they got caught, got robbed, or worse, betrayed by their own.

Francis didn't want to be like them. If he was going to do this, it had to be different. Smarter. He didn't want quick money, he wanted a future. A system.

He started slow. Silent. Observing.

He found someone, an old friend from high school who'd left for Cebu but recently returned to Gingoog with connections and confidence. They called him "Bong," not just for the name, but because of his deep involvement in the trade. Bong was street-smart and careful, and more importantly, he believed in Francis.

"You got the guts, bro," Bong said one night over a bottle of Red Horse. "But guts ain't enough. You need discipline. If you're gonna play this game, you play it like chess, not like dice."

Francis soaked up every word. He started small, moving just enough product to learn the ropes. He studied the patterns: who bought what, how often, what times were safest, which barangays were too hot to touch. He didn't flash money. He didn't post online. He kept his head down, played dumb in the daylight, and moved quietly in the dark.

He knew how dangerous this was. But he also knew something else: he was good at it.

He wasn't just selling a product, he was solving a problem. Discreetly. Respectfully. Never to kids. Never to addicts. Always

clean, always careful. And in return, he got loyalty. Clients started coming to him not just for the weed, but for the trust.

Weeks turned into months. Pesos started stacking. Bills got paid. He bought better shoes. Got his daughters new clothes. For the first time in years, he didn't feel helpless.

But the money didn't change him, it sharpened him. He reinvested, built relationships, made backup plans. He bought second hand phones, used prepaid SIMs, and memorized everything, no trace, no trail. He studied the law like a lawyer, not because he planned to get caught, but because he planned not to.

And every time doubt crept in, every time he thought about quitting, he went back to those two photos on the wall. His daughters. His "why."

"This ain't about weed," he'd whisper to himself. **"This is about winning."**

Then came the big opportunity. Bong introduced him to a grower from Bukidnon, a man with acres of land and some of the cleanest, most potent marijuana Francis had ever seen. If he could manage to handle logistics, transport, distribution, protection, he'd be able to scale fast.

It was risky. Extremely. But he felt ready. His mind was sharper. His instincts are faster. And his vision is clearer than ever.

He didn't just want to survive anymore. He wanted to build.

Not just an empire in the shadows, but a future that reached the light.

Chapter 3: Against All Odds

Success has a way of attracting two things: opportunity… and enemies.

By the time Francis Louie was making more in a week than he used to make in six months, the game had changed. What started as a survival hustle had turned into a full-blown operation. The product came from Bukidnon. The distribution was silent but steady. The money? Flowing.

But with growth came heat. People noticed.

Not the kind of people you want noticing.

It started small- whispers in the street, envious looks from old faces, rumors spread by people who wanted his spot but didn't have the courage to walk the path he walked. Then came the real threats: strangers asking too many questions, barangay tanods getting a little too curious, even some so-called friends trying to test his loyalty with bait.

Francis wasn't scared. But he was aware.

He didn't have the luxury to be sloppy. He had kids. People are relying on him. A legacy he was trying to build - even if it was built in shadows for now. Every step had to be precise. Every risk, calculated.

He changed phones often. Rotated locations. Kept his stash moving, never in the same spot twice. He didn't trust anyone fully, not even Bong. Because trust in this game was like playing with fire. Warm one minute, burning you alive the next.

He doubled down on his principles:
No selling to minors. No flashy lifestyle. No noise.
That's how people get caught, not by the police, but by their own ego.

Despite all that, Francis knew he couldn't stay in the shadows forever.

He started exploring legit business fronts, the kind that could clean the money, create legal income, and eventually free him from the underground world. He opened a small carwash and a motorbike parts shop, using cousins and neighborhood boys as staff. To the outside world, he looked like a hardworking, ambitious young man trying to make an honest living.

And in a way… he was.

Because here's the thing: Francis didn't love the weed game. He loved what it allowed him to do, feed his kids, buy land, fix his house, help his mother. He loved turning the pain into power. The hustle into hope.

One day, after a long delivery run, He sat alone in his motorbike shop, greasy hands resting on the table, watching the sun set over Gingoog City. He thought about how far he'd come, from carrying rice sacks to carrying the weight of a secret empire.

And still, nobody knew.

His daughters were growing up fast. One lived with her mother in Medina, the other in Gingoog. He couldn't be there every night. That crushed him. But every peso he earned, every risk he took, it was for them. For their future. For the days when he could finally come clean and say:

"I did it for you. And I made it out."

But getting out wasn't going to be easy. He knew that.

The law in the Philippines didn't care about your reasons. They didn't care if you were a father, a dreamer, or just another guy trying to survive. If they caught you, they buried you.

So Francis planned everything. Every move. Every alibi. Every exit strategy.

He wasn't just running a business now, he was surviving a war.

But deep down, he believed something most people never dared to believe:

That even the most illegal beginnings can lead to a legitimate legacy… if you're smart enough, quiet enough, and determined enough to make it happen.

Chapter 4: Turning Points

It started with one piece of land.

A small, half-forgotten lot just outside Gingoog is cheap, quiet, and nothing special. Just dirt, scattered banana trees, and a leaning nipa hut that looked ready to collapse. But to Francis Louie, it looked like freedom.

He paid in cash. Quiet. Clean. Ran it through the carwash to make it look legit, just another "hardworking local businessman investing in his future." No red flags. No attention.

But that land? It was more than an investment.

It was a symbol.

It meant he wasn't just surviving in the shadows anymore. He was building something in the light.

By now, Francis had small businesses running: the motorbike parts shop, the carwash, and a humble eatery managed by his cousin and her husband. All legit. Receipts. Permits. Payroll. He began funneling more money into them-cleaning it, growing it, protecting it.

But the streets weren't done with him.

He still had ties to the product. Deliveries to watch. People who depended on him from that side. You don't just walk away from what kept you alive, especially when it made you rich.

So, he tightened the circle. Cut out the sloppy ones. Refused clients who brought heat. Told Bong,

> "I'm not tryna die a legend in a headline. I'm tryna live long enough to turn this into something they can never touch."

That's when the pressure hit.

More cops. More checkpoints. More raids. People are disappearing. One of his old runners got caught and tried to drop names. But Francis had always played smart; no one knew too much. Just roles. Just silence. Just loyalty.

Still… It was too close.

That night, staring at his reflection-tired eyes, busted knuckles, a man too young to feel that old, he made a promise:

"Two more years. That's it. Then I'm out."

Out of the game. Fully clean. Fully legal.

He doubled down on the businesses. Hired smarter. Shifted to digital payments. Opened an online parts store. Learned branding. Marketing. Crypto. Anything that could grow above ground.

And he gave back, quietly.

School supplies for kids. Repairs to a busted basketball court. Groceries for families struggling in silence, just like he once did.

But he never posted. Never bragged. Never claimed credit.

Because Francis knew the truth:

God sees what the world doesn't.

That turning point-from hustle to structure, wasn't loud. Wasn't flashy. It was steady. Focused. Ruthless in its discipline.

While others chased clout or fast cash, Francis built something deeper:
A legacy.

Not just for himself.

But for Eira Fouie and Annica Louies, his daughters. His world.



The day he brought them to the land, they ran barefoot through the grass, laughing. He stood behind them, hands in his pockets, soft smile on his face.

No one would've guessed the life he lived to get here.

And that's exactly how he wanted it.

Because real power doesn't announce itself.

It just moves.

Chapter 5: Fire in the Past

Success feels good, until it starts feeling like a target on your back.

Francis Louie had been walking the tightrope between two worlds for years. By now, the car-wash was expanding, his motorcycle parts business was getting online orders from all over Mindanao, and he was even eyeing a beach side spot for a restobar in Talisayan.

But no matter how far he climbed, the streets still remembered him.

One night, while checking stock in his shop, a random motorcycle pulled up. Headlight on full beam. No plates.

Francis froze.

The rider didn't speak, just stared. Helmet stayed on. After a minute, the bike revved and sped off into the night. No words. No gunshots. But the message was clear:

"We see you."

The past wasn't just behind him, it was watching.

That week, word hit the streets that a major supplier in Bukidnon had been raided. Francis knew the name. He also knew that guy had his number once. The circle was tightening.

He went quiet. No deliveries. No meetings. He stayed low, focused on the legit side of things. But paranoia doesn't sleep, especially when you know how fast it can all come crashing down.

He thought about pulling out completely. Selling the land. Moving his daughters to Cebu. Disappearing.

But then, one night during a blackout, he sat on his rooftop looking at the dark skyline of Gingoog. No lights. Just stars. Just silence.

And that's when it hit him: he didn't come this far to run.

He came this far to win.

So he played the game differently.

Instead of going underground, he went above it. He hired a lawyer, lowkey but sharp. Registered everything legit. Filed taxes, clean money only, building a paper trail so clear it would confuse even the nosiest investigator.

He started reading business books, studying law, networking with silent mentors online. He wasn't just surviving anymore, he was becoming something greater.

But the shadows don't let go easily.

A former associate-someone Francis had cut off years ago, got desperate. Caught in a sting. And he sang like a bird. Dropped names, locations, and lies twisted with half-truths. One name echoed in that confession:

Francis Louie.

That night, Francis got the call from Bong.

"Bro… they might come. I heard your name. Be ready."

He didn't panic. He didn't run. Instead, he prepared.

He wiped old devices. Cleaned records. Burned papers. Moved anything sensitive out of reach. His legal businesses were bulletproof. But the fear? It was real. He kissed his daughters' photos, wrote two letters, just in case-and waited.

Three days passed.

Nothing.

A week.

Still nothing.

Then, like smoke in the wind, the threat vanished. Turns out the associate was so deep in lies that the authorities ignored half his story. No charges. No knock on the door. No headlines.

But Francis got the message loud and clear:

One wrong move… and it's all gone.

That night, he made the hardest decision of his life, to sever every connection to the weed game. Forever. No more deliveries. No more favors. No more chances.

He wasn't a street hustler anymore.

He was a businessman.

A father.

A survivor who beat the system that tried to cage him.

The fire of his past had almost burned his future. But instead of turning to ash, he rose from it.

Like phoenix smoke, rising from the lowlands of Gingoog.

Chapter 6: Clean Money, Clear Vision

For the first time in his life, Francis Louie woke up and didn't feel the need to look over his shoulder.

The streets weren't chasing him anymore. The shadows were behind him. And in front of him? Nothing but wide open lanes.

Clean lanes.

He'd gone full legit, and the timing couldn't have been better. The carwash had expanded into a full-blown detailing center, with a coffee shop on the side run by young locals he used to play ball with. The motorbike shop was now sourcing and selling custom parts all over **Visayas** and **Mindanao**. And his online hustle? Steady **fire**.

But it wasn't just about business now.

It was about **impact**.

Francis started sponsoring small tournaments in Gingoog-basketball leagues, dance battles, skate comps. No press, no bragging. Just giving kids something better to do than the same streets he once bled for.

He knew what it was like to be broke, hungry, angry at the world. And now that he had the power, he used it to build bridges instead of walls.

One of his proudest days came when a young dude, 17 years old, used to run errands for pushers-walked into his shop and asked for a job.

"Why me?" Francis asked.

The kid shrugged. **"'Cause people say you used to be like us. But now… you got your own stuff. You did it."**

Francis stared at him for a second.

Then handed him a broom.

"You start now."

That's how it started.

One by one, Francis pulled in people from the same **mud** he once drowned in. He taught them about money, discipline, how to save, how to build. How to move smart-not fast.

He even started a YouTube channel under a fake name, sharing business tips in Bisaya, telling anonymous stories about struggle and survival. Within months, the channel blew up. Not just in Mindanao, but across the country. People were inspired by the grind. By realness.

Still, Francis stayed in the background.

No face. No fame.

Just focus.

Meanwhile, he bought more land. Built rental apartments. Started importing bike parts directly from Japan and Thailand. Every

business was in someone else's name-cousins, siblings, friends he trusted. He didn't need the spotlight. He needed stability.

He even started talks with a lawyer and a small tech team about building a delivery app focused on small cities in Mindanao-food, motor parts, even small groceries. Something homegrown, something local. Something that made people feel like the province could compete with Manila.

And the best part?

Every cent that came in now… was clean.

No stress. No paranoia. Just **legacy**.

But even with all the wins, Francis never forgot where he came from.

He visited his daughters more often. Spent more time with his mom. Fixed her house. Put her on a **monthly allowance**. Helped Erica and Leira with side hustles so they could support themselves too.

He didn't throw money at problems, he solved them.

Because that's what real ones do.

The day he looked at his bank app and saw seven digits-real money, taxed and traceable, he smiled. Not a flex smile. A peaceful one.

Because he knew something the system never wanted him to know:

You can be born in the dirt… and still grow into gold.

Chapter 7: Seed to Empire Every empire starts with a seed.

For Francis Louie, that seed wasn't just money, it was mindset.

He didn't get lucky. He got smart.

While most people were flexing fast cash or chasing clout, Francis was in the lab. Quietly. Consistently. He studied supply and demand. Watched YouTube videos on e-commerce and passive income. Took notes from small-time sari-sari store owners who were killing it without even realizing it.

His first legit win? A motorbike parts kiosk.

Tiny spot. Rusty signage. No aircon. But he picked the perfect location-right along a busy road in Gingoog, where riders passed every morning like clockwork. He stocked parts no one else in town carried: custom bolts, unique decals, headlight mods.

Within 6 months, his inventory was moving faster than he could replace it.

His secret? Talk less, listen more. He asked his customers what they wanted, what they couldn't find, what prices they could afford. Then he delivered.

He reinvested every peso.

No fancy clothes. No big nights out. Just stock, storage, and slow stacking.

Next move? The carwash.

But not just water and soap. Francis added full detailing, engine cleaning, and a coffee corner with budget iced drinks and bread. The twist? He partnered with a local bakery for supply and split profits. Win-win.

People came for a wash and left with merienda. Business doubled in 3 months.

He hired his high school homies, the ones still stuck or jobless. Trained them. Taught them punctuality, hygiene, and sales talk. For every customer they brought in, he gave commission. The carwash became a community hub.

Then came the online hustle.

Francis knew people in provinces loved ordering unique parts. The problem was, most didn't know how to shop online. So he created a system: walk-in orders. People visited his shop, chose what they wanted from a tablet, paid in cash, and he'd order for them. He charged a small fee and made bulk shipments using his Shipito and Shopee connections.

Suddenly, he was the bridge between the locals and the global market.

Still, that wasn't enough.

Francis wanted something scalable. Something he could hand down to his daughters one day. That's when he created Louie Ventures, not just a name, but a system of structure.

Every business, from the carwash to the rentals, had a dedicated person managing it. All trained by him. All loyal. He built internal

systems: profit tracking, weekly reviews, inventory audits. He paid SSS, Pag-IBIG, PhilHealth for his staff. People felt respected, and worked harder.

He didn't boss them.

He built them.

And when people asked him how he did it, he said the same thing every time:

"I planted seeds in the dark. Watered them with patience. Now they grow in the light."

His name was starting to float around, not as a dealer or hustler, but as a builder. A quiet genius from Gingoog who turned dirt into diamonds.

A few local officials even offered him contracts, small deals to supply parts for government vehicles or clean certain barangay vehicles. He took them. Delivered on time. No kickbacks, no bribes. Just results.

The more legit he became, the more powerful he felt.

Not from fear.

But from freedom.

Freedom to walk into city hall with clean books.

Freedom to sit with investors and not flinch.

Freedom to look his daughters in the eye and say:

"This world won't hand you anything. But if you work smart, if you move with heart… you'll never be empty-handed."

That was the difference now.

Before, he was surviving.

Now, he was leading.

Chapter 8: Daughters of a King

Francis Louie had lived both sides of life, the dark alleys and the lit-up skylines. He'd touched fast money, survived cold nights, and outplayed danger.

But nothing made him feel more alive than the sound of two small voices saying:

"Papa."

One came from **Eira Fouie** - his youngest, full of curiosity and wild laughter, always tugging at his shirt and asking questions about bikes, engines, and birds.

The other was **Annica Louise** - older by a few months, quiet but sharp, always watching, always thinking. She reminded Francis of himself.

They had different mothers. Different homes. Different routines.

But they shared the same father, and that meant everything to Francis.

He knew he wasn't perfect. Hell, he didn't even know what being a father really meant when he first held them. He just knew one thing:
He couldn't fail them.
Not like how he'd been failed.

Growing up, Francis didn't have a dad around to teach him how to move, how to protect, how to love with presence. His mom did her

best, no doubt.
But the streets taught him most of what he knew, and not always in the kindest ways.

That's why he swore to break the cycle.

He didn't want to be just the dad who showed up with toys.
He wanted to be the dad who showed up with **time**.

Even with his businesses booming, Francis carved out space every week for his daughters. No missed birthdays. No broken promises.
They didn't always understand what he did for work, but they understood his love.

Sometimes, he'd take them on weekend rides through the hills of Misamis Oriental, stopping by waterfalls or roadside stores.
He'd tell them stories, not about weed, not about the hustle, but about dreams.

He'd kneel beside them and say:

"You two… you're the reason I stayed alive. You're the reason I stopped risking everything.
I don't want to just leave you money. I want to leave you the meaning."

He started small savings accounts for both of them. Bought land in their names.
Made plans for educational funds — not because he wanted them to follow his path,
but because he wanted them to **choose their own.**

And the wild part?

Both mothers, Erica and Leira started to see the change.

They didn't fully forgive him. The past still hurts.
But they saw the effort. The growth. The difference.

Francis stopped chasing affection, and started earning respect.

One day, while watching the sunset from a beach in Balingoan, Annica and Eira asked,
"Papa, are we rich now?"

Francis chuckled. Then answered real:

"We're rich in lessons. In time. In second chances.
The money's just paper. But you two? You're the real treasure."

He meant it.

No matter how much money he stacked…
No matter how far his empire stretched…
His greatest investment would always be the legacy he was building inside his daughters.

He taught them kindness.
Taught them boundaries.
Taught them to pray. To think.
To never let pain make them hard.

Because one day, when the world asks who Francis Louie really was,
he wanted them to say:

"He was our hero.
Not because he was perfect, but because he never stopped fighting to be better."

Chapter 9: The Art of Disguise

By now, Francis Louie owned businesses in places where his name wasn't even on the paperwork and that was by design.

While others chased fame, Francis chased freedom.

He learned early that the loudest man in the room is usually the weakest. So he flipped the game, made himself small while his moves stayed massive.

In public, he looked like any other tricycle-riding guy. Sometimes in slippers. No gold chains. No designer drip. No security. Just Francis, low-key, calm, calculating.

But behind the curtain?

He was running:

- A detailing center with three branches
- A booming motorcycle parts resell business
- A growing rental empire with steady passive income
- A logistics link connecting Mindanao shops with Luzon suppliers
- And an equity stake in a startup building a rural delivery app

And nobody could trace it all back to him.

How?

Because he mastered the art of legal camouflage.

He registered ventures under other names. Put shares in trusted hands. Built systems that ran on autopilot. Even if someone tried to dig, they'd only find fragments, never the full picture.

He played the game like chess, not checkers.

"Power is best held in silence," he once told a friend. "Let the noise chase attention. I'll chase results."

Still, Francis wasn't paranoid, just prepared.

He paid taxes. Hired accountants. Keeps clean paper trails. Any risky parts of his past? He buried them deep, slowly phasing them out while legal income washed over old sins like rain on concrete.

No Facebook flexing. No TikTok hustle posts. No **"grind"** captions.

He let his work and his people speak for him.

And they did.

They said he gave them jobs. Helped kids stay in school. Donated supplies during typhoons. Sponsored feeding programs without attaching his name. Quietly showed up when a family needed funeral funds.

The streets started calling him ***The Ghost King***, the man nobody saw coming, but everybody felt.

Even politicians started to notice. Some respected how he moved. Others got too curious.

So Francis adjusted again.

He scaled back appearances. Let his people do the talking. Made sure no one had the full map.

He even trained two of his closest boys to be public faces, business reps who looked like they ran the show. But behind the curtain, they always circled back to the brain.

And through it all, Francis never lost sight of the mission:

Protect the vision. Protect the family. Protect the peace.

He wasn't just building wealth anymore.

He was building a kingdom;
One where his daughters could grow up without fear.
One where Gingoog kids could dream past the block.
One where you didn't have to die young to be remembered.

He didn't want monuments.

He wanted movements.

And that's exactly what he was building,
From the shadows.
With precision.
With purpose.

Chapter 10: When Legends Are Still Alive

It started with a DM.

A film student from Manila slid into one of the pages connected to Louie Ventures. The message was short:

> **"Heard of a guy from Gingoog who built an empire from nothing. No fame. No interviews. Just pure hustle. I want to tell his story."**

At first, Francis ignored it.

He wasn't in the game for cameras. He didn't need the world to clap for him. He had already won, his girls were fed, his people had work, and his businesses ran like clockwork.

But curiosity crept in.

Who was watching? Who was paying attention?

Two weeks later, another message came in, this time from an independent media group based in Cebu. They'd heard whispers of ***The Ghost King of Mindanao*** and wanted to produce a mini-documentary about hidden Filipino entrepreneurs reshaping rural economies.

This time, Francis didn't ignore it.

He didn't say yes, either.

He called a meeting with his two closest boys, his public faces, his lieutenants.

> "If the story's gonna be told," he said, "we tell it our way. No drugs. No past dirt. Just the rise. The community. The blueprint."

The goal? **Control the narrative. Inspire, not flex. Teach, not preach.**

A month later, a small crew arrived in Gingoog. No big lights. Just cameras, mics, and respect.

They filmed the bike shop. The carwash. The land Francis bought for a youth center he planned to build someday.

They captured him walking through the market, greeting vendors by name.

They caught him laughing with his daughters, helping Annica fix the tire on her kiddie bike, or carrying Eira on his shoulders near the pier.

They filmed the quiet moments too, when he just stood, staring at the hills, probably thinking about the mountain where he once dreamed of putting a sign bigger than life.

> **"You ever think you're a legend, Kuya Francis?"** the cameraman asked once.

Francis looked at the ocean, then back at him.

> **"A legend? Nah. I'm just a reminder. That no matter how deep you fall, if you believe in your**

next step, you can walk out of hell like you own it."

That line made the cut. It became the doc's title.

"Walk Out of Hell: The Quiet Rise of Francis Louie"

It dropped quietly on YouTube, just a 22-minute feature.

But it hit like lightning.

Thousands watched. Then hundreds of thousands. But it wasn't the views that mattered, it was the messages.

Young fathers from Bukidnon messaged him, saying they cried watching it.

Street kids from Davao said it gave them hope.

Overseas workers said it reminded them of home, and of what's still possible when they return.

Suddenly, Francis wasn't just a local name anymore.

He was a symbol.

Not of perfection. But of **possibility**.

And the best part? He never even showed his full face on camera. He let the visuals speak. Let the voice-overs carry the story. Kept the mystery intact.

Because at the end of the day, Francis Louie didn't care about followers.

He cared about **impact**.

And that documentary?

It was just the beginning.

He started getting invites, college talks, mentorship programs, even a soft offer from a legit publisher to turn his story into a book.

He didn't jump.

He thought.

He prayed.

Then he said what he always said:

> ***"If I tell it, I'll tell it right. For the broken. For the hungry. For the ones who still believe they're too far gone."***

Chapter 11: The Blueprint for the Broken

By now, Francis Louie wasn't just a name.
He was a signal.

To every soul treading water in the deep, no rope, no rescue in sight, he was proof:
You can still build a ship from the wreckage.

This chapter isn't about flex.
It's about **passing the torch**.

Because Francis knew what it felt like to be broken,
Financially. Emotionally. Spiritually.
He had been there. In the mud. In the silence. In shame.

But out of all that, he built a **code**.
Not from books.
Not from podcasts.
But from pain and practice.

Here's the blueprint:

---

1. Never Beg for Respect. Earn It in Silence.

Francis didn't broadcast his goals.
He just **moved differently**, quietly, consistently.

He let the results do the talking.
Respect followed, not because of noise, but because of **discipline**.

"You don't have to prove them wrong.
Just prove yourself right."

---

2. Pain Is the Tax You Pay for Greatness.

He never ran from hurt.
He **used it**, sharpened his hunger with it, fueled his grind.

Every betrayal? A lesson.
Every loss? A wake-up call.
Every low point? A stepping stone.

"Cry tonight if you must.
Just don't live there."

---

3. Protect Your Energy. Not Everyone Deserves Access.

Once Francis started building, he became **selective**.
Not everyone got a seat at the table.
Some came with knives, not forks.

He learned to spot leeches.
Learned to say **no**.
Learned to move in **alignment**, not attachment.

"If they don't feed your fire,
don't let them near your fuel."

4. Stack Legal. Stack Smart. Stack Slow If You Must.

He never rushed the bag.
Started small. Made mistakes. Recalibrated.

But once momentum hit, he stopped surviving and started **strategizing**.

He studied systems. Studied the law.
Switched from risky plays to **righteous ones**.

> ***"Real wealth doesn't vanish in a raid.***
> ***It gets protected."***

---

5. Lead with Loyalty. Never Forget the Roots.

No matter how far he climbed, Francis **never left his people**.

His crew? Day ones.
His barbershop? Still gives free cuts every Friday to street kids.
That tricycle driver who once loaned him fare? Now runs one of his rentals.

> ***"If I eat, we eat.***
> ***If I win, we build."***

---

6. Be the Parent You Needed.

Every business move had one silent goal:
Be the man his daughters could look up to.

He didn't want them to inherit trauma.
He wanted them to inherit **tools**, and a future.

Love. Legacy. Land. Lessons.

> ***"My wealth isn't money.***
> ***It's the lives I helped shape."***

---

7. Legacy Over Likes.

Francis never chased clout.
No selfies in Lambos. No cash on tables.

Just real ones whispering his name in **prayers**.
Just children sleeping safe in homes he helped build.
Just strangers who found hope in his story.

> ***"Fame fades.***
> ***Impact lasts."***

This blueprint wasn't born overnight.
It took five years to catch on fire.
Of mistakes, betrayal, lost time, quiet prayers, silent battles and silent wins.

When people look at Francis Louie now, they don't see perfection.

They see a **rebuilt man**. Hardened by struggle. Refined by faith.
Proof that the broken can rise and even **lead**.

And maybe that's what makes a legend…

Not because he was untouchable.
But because he was **real**.

CHAPTER 12: This Is Why I Can't Fold

Before it all started, I wasn't just broke. I was broken.
Battered by life's cruel blows before I even got the chance to stand.
Not just empty pockets, but a shattered spirit, fractured by the pain of loss, betrayal, and fights I never asked for.
This shit wasn't just hard, it was ruthless. It tore me down before I could even rise.

They don't see the ghosts I fight at night.
The ones that whisper in my dreams.
Not fiction, real faces, real names, real pain.
I don't just carry ambition. I carry the weight of the dead.

First, it was Leira's father, taken by a motor accident before I could ever shake his hand and say,
"Sir, I got your daughter."

Then Erica's dad, taken by illness, like time just ran out too fast.
I never met them. But I still owe them.

And it didn't stop there...

Leira's mother, brain tumor.
Erica's grandparents, gone to age and silence.
Then my cousin, a blood clot in the brain after his own crash.
He was more than family. He was one of the few who understood me.

Just when I thought I couldn't carry more...

Leira's mom passed away, pregnant.
And that's how Rhys — my first son — came into this world.
Born into fire. A light during my darkest hour.

You think I could fold after all that?
Nah.
You think I could walk away from this vision that's now bigger than me?
Never.

This isn't about chasing fame.
It's about leaving a blueprint, a trail of truth for the next soul who feels like giving up.

It's about telling my daughters, my son, and the universe:
I'm still standing. Still writing. Still going.

I don't care if they laugh. If they doubt.
Because now I know, if your dream doesn't scare you, it's too small.

So if you're wondering why I never quit…
This is why I can't fold.
Because I still owe them everything.
Because the mountain I'm climbing is built on graves, ghosts, and God's grace.

And this is how legends are born.

Chapter 13: When Faith Breaks — The Case and the Cage

Burdens didn't stop with the deaths already etched into his soul. No, another storm was coming—a system built to silence him, to break him down piece by piece.

Leira filed a case against him. Psychological abuse.
A charge that cut deeper than any wound, because it wasn't just about the law—it was about a faith lost.
Faith in him. Faith in what they once had.
After the losses, the grief, the unbearable weight of death, she gave up.
She turned her back and fought in the only way she knew.

The world suddenly closed in.
A man who had already carried the ghosts of the dead was now facing the cold steel bars of injustice.
His parents—his lifeline—scrambled desperately, fighting against the clock and the cold machinery of the law.
They hunted for bail bonds like warriors searching for a last chance, refusing to let him be swallowed whole.

And against all odds, they pulled him back from the brink—out of the cage.

Freedom came with scars.
He reached out to Leira—not with anger, but with the hope that what was broken could be mended.
At first, she stood like a fortress, guarded and cold. The pain had made her hard.

But days passed.
Walls cracked.
And eventually, she agreed to settle.

But he never stopped moving.

He didn't waste breath blaming Leira, not fully.
Because even if the case was unjust, twisted by fear and heartbreak, he understood the storm she was in.
He held no grudge loud enough to drown his progress.
No bitterness strong enough to make him fold.

Instead, he moved with precision—sharp, smart, and smooth—like a master navigating a battlefield.
Each step forward was fueled by pain, yes, but also by a fire that refused to be snuffed out.

This wasn't just survival.
This was a declaration.

He was still here.
Still fighting.
Still building in silence like legend.

No cage, no accusation, no broken faith could hold him down.

Because some battles aren't just fought in courtrooms or behind bars—they're fought in the soul.
And his soul was unbreakable.

Chapter 14: The Mountain and the Message

The sky was a shade of blue that only shows up after a storm, like the heavens themselves had been scrubbed clean.

Francis Louie stood at the foot of Mt. Balatukan.
Alone.

No bodyguards.
No cameras.
No crew.

Just him.
The wind.
The earth beneath his feet…
And everything he'd been carrying in his soul.

It had been five years since he last stood here,
back when he was just a **broke dreamer**, with bloodshot eyes, sore feet,
and a fire in his chest **nobody else could see**.

He remembered that night vividly.

He had climbed halfway up the trail, barely eaten,
and slumped onto a rock to smoke and pray,
to ask the mountain to remember him.

> ***"If I ever make it, I'll come back.***
> ***I'll stand right here… and I'll say thank you."***

And here he was.

Millionaire. Mentor. Father. **Man of myth.**

But standing on that trail,
he didn't feel big.

He felt small again.

Not weak, just **humbled**.
Like he was in the presence of something older than time.
Something sacred.

He sat on the same rock.

Pulled out a small bottle of lambanog.
Didn't drink it. Just poured a little into the soil.
Like an offering. Like a tribute.

> ***"To the ones who didn't make it," he whispered.***
> ***"To the ones still climbing.***
> ***To the ones who never believed in me…***
> ***and to the ones who always did."***

Then he reached into his pack and pulled out a folded cloth.
Inside it: a custom-made miniature sign.

LOUIEWOOD

He smiled.

It wasn't the giant Hollywood-style signage he once dreamed of planting across the peak,
but this small one meant more.

Because this one was **earned**.

Not stolen.
Not smuggled.
Built.

He dug a small hole beside the rock and planted the sign gently.

"It ain't about how big it is," he muttered.
"It's about what it stands for."

And what it stood for was this:

That a poor, broken, misunderstood soul from Gingoog City
could build an empire from ash.

That even if the world counts you out,
the mountain always remembers.

That even the darkest parts of your story
can become someone else's light.

He sat there for an hour. Maybe more.

No noise.
No distractions.
Just breathing. Reflecting. Healing.

He thought about his daughters, Eira and Annica.
He thought about the pain.
The friends he lost.
The love he couldn't hold onto.

He thought about Leira's father…
About Erica's dad…

About the things he couldn't fix,
but could still learn from.

He thought about the fire.

The one that once burned out of anger…
now burning for **purpose**.

Then slowly, he stood.

Wiped his hands on his jeans.
Took one last look at the sign.
And smiled.

> "You kept me going when nothing else did," he told the mountain.
> "And I swear… I'll keep the message alive."

With that, Francis Louie turned his back on the mountain,
not out of disrespect,
but because he knew:

He didn't need to climb it again.

He had already become it.

Chapter 15: Planting Seeds, Not Statues.



The world wanted to build a statue for Francis Louie.

Carve his face into marble. Name streets after him. Erect a golden monument by the sea.

But he said no.

"Statues don't feed kids. Statues don't heal trauma. Statues don't change lives."

He didn't want his name frozen in stone.
He wanted it in motion, to move, to grow, to breathe.

So he chose seeds over statues.

And the first seed?
The Louie Legacy Foundation.

---

1. The Streets Ain't a School

He started with the tricycle boys. The jeepney hustlers. The cigarette vendors.
The kids he used to see every day, the ones with dirt on their knees and fire in their eyes.

Instead of handing them pesos that disappeared in a day, he gave them an opportunity.

▨ Free workshops on small business.
💻 Computers donated to barangay learning centers.
📚 Books written in Bisaya, Tagalog, and English, stories they could see themselves in.

He built a center in Gingoog.
Nothing fancy. Just open space, a whiteboard, good Wi-Fi, and one rule:

"You can come in broke, but you ain't leaving without a blueprint."

---

2. The Mothers Club

Francis never forgot the women who raised warriors.

He gave single moms priority grants.
Taught them how to start sari-sari stores, online businesses, and food stalls.

He hired mothers as managers in his legal ventures, laundry shops, motor parts stores, even a small local cannabis wellness center that operated abroad.

"You gave birth to nations, now build empires."

---

3. Eira and Annica's Fund

Named after his daughters, this was his most personal project.

A scholarship fund, not just for the smartest kids, but for the most determined.
No entrance exam. Just one question:

"What's your dream, and what's stopping you?"

If a kid had heart, Francis would cover everything:
Tuition. Allowance. Food. Even mentoring.

Because he knew, a hungry genius is still just hungry if nobody helps him eat.

---

4. From Shadows to Shares

For those walking the same line he once did, stuck between poverty and prison, he launched a second-chance program.

Former pushers. Hustlers. Ex-convicts.

They learned legit trades: Carpentry. Tech repair. Graphics. Farming.

Then he partnered with them.

"You were soldiers in the streets. Now be soldiers for your family."

He didn't just preach forgiveness, he practiced it.
Because the world judges by the past. But Francis? He saw the potential.

---

5. Louiewood Isn't a Place, It's a Movement

That small "Louiewood" sign up Mt. Balatukan?

It became a symbol.

People started using the word **"Louiewood"** to describe a mindset:
➡ A comeback story.
➡ A rise from nothing.
➡ A dream chased even when it looked suicidal.

T-shirts were printed.
Songs were written.
Murals were painted across Northern Mindanao.

Kids would point to the mountain and say:

"One day, I'll build my own Louiewood."

And that's what Francis wanted all along,
Not to be worshipped… but to be multiplied.

He didn't want to be remembered for how high he climbed.
He wanted to be remembered for how many hands he pulled up on the way.

Statues crack.
Streets fade.
But seeds grow forever.

Chapter 16: The World Was Watching

It started with a post.
Just a photo he'd saved in his files from his last climb.

Francis Louie, standing on Mt. Balatukan, a tiny "LOUIEWOOD" sign beside him, clouds below, and a caption that read:

"From the dirt to the peak.
From broken to blessed.
From nobody… to a seed planter."

He didn't tag anyone. He wasn't looking for likes.
But the universe had other plans.

By sunrise, it was viral.

First in Mindanao.
Then across the Philippines.
Then… international.

Netflix in the Inbox

A message hit his official Facebook page:

> *"Hi, this is Camille from Netflix Originals, Southeast Asia. We've been following your story since Chapter 7, we'd love to talk about adapting it."*

Francis blinked at the screen.

He laughed.
Not because it was funny, but because five years ago, he'd been Googling how to hide weed in banana boxes…

Now Netflix was knocking.

CNN. BBC. VICE.

The headlines exploded like wildfire:

- *"Gingoog City's Underground King Turned Youth Savior"*
- *"From Dealer to Dreamer: The Louiewood Revolution"*
- *"Meet the Filipino Who Rewrote His Fate — One Seed at a Time"*

They all came knocking.

Some wanted interviews.
Some wanted a documentary.
Some just wanted a piece of the story.

But Francis?
He wasn't playing celebrity.

He made a rule:

"If you're not helping my city, don't touch my name."

Hollywood Meets Louiewood

Then came a man named David Roman, an executive producer who once worked on *Narcos* and *Queen of the South*.

He flew straight to Laguindingan Airport.
No suits. No cameras. Just one line:

"This isn't a drug story, it's a human story.
And I want the world to feel that."

They shook hands.

Not on a contract.

But on a promise:

"If my daughters can watch it someday and feel proud, it's a go."

The Philippines Reacts

The country was split.

Some praised him as a visionary, a voice for the voiceless, a modern hero.

Others called him a criminal wrapped in gold,
a glorified outlaw who just got lucky.

But Francis didn't fight back.

He never answered the hate.
He just kept building.

> **"Let my work argue for me," he'd say.**
> **"I didn't come to explain, I came to plant."**

The House at Sea Level

With international attention, Francis didn't move to a mansion in Manila or buy a villa in Spain.

He stayed in Gingoog, at sea level.
In the same house between the mountain and the ocean —
the house he once dreamed about during sleepless nights.

He rebuilt it with local labor.
He made sure every nail drove opportunity home.

And every morning, he'd stand outside
with coffee in one hand, weed in the other, and whisper:

"Let them watch. I'm just getting started."

Louiewood: The Documentary

The film finally dropped.

It didn't just break records, it broke hearts.
It made people cry, cheer, and reflect.

It showed:

- The guilt of missing two fathers' deaths.
- The chaos of raising two daughters in two homes.
- The loneliness of being rich but misunderstood.

- The beauty of not giving up, even when everything screams at you to stop.

In the last scene, it returned to Mt. Balatukan.
And in Francis' voice, the final line:

"They watched me burn.
Now they watch me bloom.
This is Louiewood.
And this... is just the trailer."

Chapter 17: The Bloodline Dream



The rain was soft that day. No thunder, no storm, just a calm drizzle on the glass windows of the sea-level house.

Inside, Francis Louie sat with his two daughters for the first time… not just as a father… but as a man ready to tell the whole truth.

Eira Fouie was 6.
Annica Louise was almost 7.

Too young for some stories.
But too smart for lies.

---

1. "I'm Not a Perfect Man"

Francis sat on the floor with them, no bodyguards, no cameras, no assistants.
Just him.
Two bowls of champorado.
And a truth that needed to be planted like a seed.

"Daddy made mistakes. Big ones.
I didn't grow up with money.
I didn't grow up with a map.
But I had a dream… and I held on when nobody believed in me.
Even when I was illegal. Even when I was alone."

Eira looked at him, eyes wide.
Annica hugged his arm.

They didn't say a word. But their silence? It gave him strength.

---

2. "You Were My Light When I Was In The Dark"

He pulled out a dusty notebook, pages filled with scribbles, goals, and drawings of houses, signage, and the names "Eira" and "Annica" circled with hearts.

"I wrote this back when I had nothing but hope and weed in my pocket.
You girls were just babies.
But you were already the reason I couldn't quit."

They flipped through the pages.
He showed them his first business plan.
Then his second.
Then the fake names he used to dodge customs when shipping parts for his motor. 😂

They giggled.
They understood.
They felt it.

---

3. "A Legacy Ain't Just Land, It's Love."

"You see this house? I built it with blood.
But what I leave you isn't the house.
It's the mindset.

If you fall, don't stay down.
If you get hated, don't stop.
If people doubt you, prove them wrong in silence."

He handed them each a necklace, one made of silver, the other gold.

Inside each one, a seed.

"This seed? Plant it when you're ready.
It's not for farming.
It's a reminder that you, too, were born to grow."

---

4. "One Day, You'll Tell Your Own Chapter"

Francis wasn't trying to control his daughters.
He didn't care if they became business owners, doctors, or dancers.
He just wanted one thing:

"Promise me… when people ask where you came from…
You won't say 'from the ghetto'…
Say: I came from a father who broke the curse… so I could write my own blessing."

They nodded.
They didn't fully understand yet.

But they would.

In time.

---

5. The Final Line

That night, after they fell asleep…

Francis walked out to his porch.
The mountain stood tall in the distance, hidden by fog, but he could feel it — his "Louiewood."

He whispered under his breath:

"I didn't just change my life.
I changed my bloodline."

No flex.
No post.

Just a man… finally at peace…
with the future he used to dream about under the stars.

Chapter 18: The One Who Tried to Stop It All

You ever get that feeling?
Like a shadow from the past is about to knock on your front door?
That's what Francis felt that Tuesday morning.

He was in the middle of a business call when his security radio buzzed.

> "Boss, there's a guy here. Says he knows you.
> Brought no ID. Just… pain in his eyes."

Francis paused.

> "Name?"

> "Gideon."

Flashback: Five Years Ago

Before the businesses.
Before the millions.
Before the Louiewood dreams even started forming…

There was **Gideon**, a former barangay tanod turned **anti-drug enforcer**, and one of the first people who tried to **shut Francis down**.

Back in the early days, when Francis was moving seeds through crates of bananas and tires, Gideon nearly caught him.

Twice.

And on the third attempt… he *almost* got him locked up.

But Francis disappeared for a year, laid low, vanished in the hills, and built the very strategy that made him a ghost in the system.

That ghost became a legend.
That legend became a movement.

And now?

That same enforcer was standing outside the gates of his mansion, **unarmed and unannounced**.

"Let Him In."

Francis told the guards to back off.

No weapons. No drama.

He met Gideon in the garden.
The same place he once planted his first legit marijuana seed, the one that would later become the face of his wellness brand, **Balatukan Botanicals**.

Gideon looked older now.
Wrinkled. Broken. But not beaten.

"You remember me?" he asked.

Francis nodded.

> "You're the reason I learned to move smart. You almost caught me.
> I should thank you."

Gideon didn't smile.

Instead, he pulled out a folded letter, yellowed with age.

> "I wrote this five years ago. Never had the guts to send it."

Francis opened it.

The words were shaky… but real.

The Letter of Regret

> *"Francis, I was just doing my job.*
> *But in trying to destroy your hustle, I ignored your hunger.*
> *I forgot you were just a man trying to feed his kids.*
> *I followed orders.*
> *But I lost myself.*
> *And in the end… while you were rising, I was falling.*
> *I lost my badge. My house. My son doesn't speak to me.*
> *I'm not here to ask for anything.*
> *I'm just here to say… I see you now.*
> *And I'm sorry."*

The Silence That Said Everything

Francis looked up from the letter.

No words.
No anger.
Just… a long stare.

Then, finally:

> "You thought I was the enemy.
> I wasn't your enemy, Gideon. I was just the mirror…
> showing you what you weren't ready to face."

Gideon nodded.

> "I know that now."

> "So what do you want from me?"

> "Nothing," Gideon said. "But if ever… you need someone who knows the old system… who knows where the snakes still hide… I'm offering what I got left."

Francis smirked.

> "Have you ever planted a seed before?"

> "No."

> "Then grab a shovel. The past ends here."

Enemies into Gardeners

That day, Francis didn't just forgive Gideon.

He hired him.

Not as a bodyguard. Not as an informant.

As a **gardener**, the one who now manages the plants at the Louiewood Sanctuary, where troubled youth are taught to grow food, medicine, and peace instead of chaos.

People were shocked when they heard.

> "Why would you hire the man who tried to ruin you?"

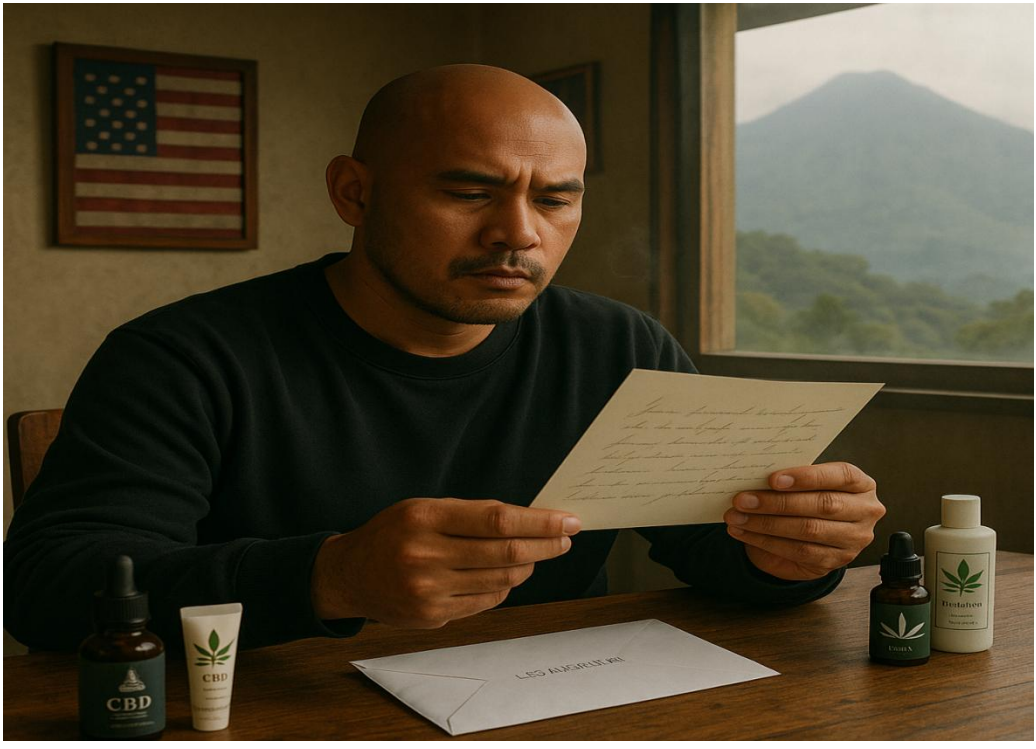
Francis answered simply:

> ***"If I stayed mad, I'd still be broke.***
> ***But if I build with even my enemies?***
> ***I'll stay rich forever."***

Chapter 19: The Letter from L.A.

It was a humid Friday afternoon in Gingoog.
Francis had just wrapped up a shoot for his latest cannabis skincare brand when one of his staff rushed over, holding a clean white envelope with an American stamp.

"Sir… this came from Los Angeles. Hand-delivered by a courier.



No return name. Just says: 'To Francis Louie, the one who never gave up.'"

Francis raised an eyebrow.

He took the envelope, felt the texture, thick, premium paper. Heavy.

Someone spent money to get this to me.

He slid a blade through the edge and opened it.

Inside was a single letter.

Handwritten. Elegant cursive.
At the bottom: "C.F."

The Letter:

"I don't know you. But I know your energy.
A film student in L.A. showed me your story, your rise from poverty, your love for your daughters, your hustle in the shadows that grew into a legacy of light.

I was born into everything. I lost it all. And when I was about to jump from a rooftop last year… someone showed me a clip of you talking about how your darkest nights were just the universe testing your fire.

You said: **'If the world says no, shout yes from the mountaintop.'**
That line pulled me back from the edge. Gave me breath when the world was silent.

I don't need a reply.
I just need you to know… you changed someone in L.A.
And that someone is now changing others.

Never stop, Louie. You're not just a man.
You're a movement."

– C.F."

Francis Sat There Silent.
Not many things shook him anymore.

But this?

This… hit different.

He wasn't shocked that someone from L.A. wrote to him.

He was shocked someone halfway across the world felt him.

Not for the money.
Not for the headlines.
But for the truth he lived.

He looked out the window, saw Mt. Balatukan in the distance, his Louiewood vision carved into his mind like destiny.

And for a moment, all the years of hiding, hustling, hurting, they melted.

This was it.
This was why.

"From Gingoog to Global."
He called his team.

“Draft a reply. No PR filter. No brand spin. Just me.”

They handed him a tablet.

But Francis waved it away.

“No. Handwritten. I want them to feel it like I felt theirs.”

He grabbed a pen.

Francis Louie’s Reply (Snippets):

“Dear C.F.,
I don’t know who you are. But I know you’re a warrior.
The world tried to break us both, and we said not today."

"You saw my story, but now I’m seeing yours.
That’s how energy works. That’s how purpose moves.”

“When the film of my life plays in the stars, I hope there’s a scene where two souls connect across oceans… because of pain, fire, and faith.”

“If you ever come to the Philippines, there’s a seat at my table, a joint in my hand, and a garden where peace grows tall.”

“From Gingoog to L.A. We’re not strangers. We’re survivors."

- F.L.”

The Fire Keeps Spreading
Francis didn't post the letter.
Didn't go viral with it.

He just folded it, sealed it, and sent it back.

Because this journey?

It wasn't for likes.
It was for lives.

And with each letter, each seed, each step…

Francis Louie was becoming more than a millionaire.

He was becoming a message.

Chapter 20: Balatukan Summit

"From shadows to summit, the fire rises."

The climb was steep.

Not just the **mountain**, but the **moment**.

Francis stood at the halfway point of **Mt. Balatukan**, overlooking the city that once forgot his name, **Gingoog**. Behind him were tents, speakers, security, and smoke from cannabis incense drifting through the air like spirit smoke.

This was no ordinary gathering.

This was **history**.

A multi-sector summit where no suits or politicians were invited… unless they were ready to **listen**, not lead.

Who Was There?

- **Farmers** from Bukidnon and Misamis, the real OGs of the land, tired of selling crops for pennies.

- **Young tech heads** from CDO, dreamers with laptops, building apps for plant tracking and crypto trade.

- **Ex-bureau agents** turned believers, once chasing Louie, now learning from him.

- **NGOs**, **Hollywood documentarians**, and even a **representative from a Dutch cannabis research group** who flew in unannounced.

And front row?

His two daughters.

Eira Fouie and **Annica Louise**, both wearing little jackets with embroidered logos:
"Daughters of the Flame."

The Stage Was Made of Bamboo.

No podium.
No microphone.
Just Francis standing with the wind behind him and **truth in his chest**.

He lit a joint, took a puff, then held it out like a mic drop.

> *"Five years ago, I was hiding in banana crates.*
> *Now I'm planting legacies.*
> *We are not criminals, we are cultivators of change."*

The Vibe Shifted.

He told them about his first grow.
About selling to survive.
About dodging death and police while changing diapers and chasing freedom.

Then he dropped **the proposal**:

"The Balatukan Treaty"

1. **Protected Grow Zones** - Empower local farmers to grow cannabis legally and safely under tribal protection.

2. **Community Reintegration for Ex-Offenders** - Teach the trade, not the trauma.

3. **Revenue Redistribution Model** - 40% of profit goes back to the barangays, 10% to mental health and rehab, and 50% into business expansion and education.

4. **Cannabis Cultural Tourism** - Guided trips to Louiewood. Grow, heal, and learn.

And Then the Twist…

A *drone* flew overhead.

Projecting a **hologram** of a Hollywood producer on a nearby tarp screen, the same guy Francis ghosted last month.

"Francis, this is Jackson Ray from Evolve Studios.
We watched your summit live.
We want to turn your story into a series.
Real names. Real places. Real change."

The crowd erupted.

But Francis stayed cool.

"Only if I get final cut.
This story ain't fiction.
It's truth therapy."

What Happened Next?

That night, under the stars, they signed it.
Every representative from every walk of life put their fingerprints on a giant hemp-leaf scroll.

The Balatukan Treaty wasn't just signed. It was born — in fire, ink, and fingerprints.

No media.
No press kits.
Just fire, freedom, and fellowship.

As the summit ended, Francis looked at his daughters:

"This is your inheritance. Not money. Not power.
Freedom. Vision. Respect."

They nodded.

Even the mountain seemed to whisper:

"Well done, son of Gingoog."

Chapter 21: Louiewood Rises

"If Hollywood has a hill, then Gingoog got a God-level view."

6:00 AM.
Mist rolled through the trees of **Mt. Balatukan** like whispers from the ancestors.
Birds cried out in the distance.
And on a steep mountainside, a crew of locals, farmers, artists, ex-cons, and engineers stood shoulder to shoulder, looking up.

The steel beams had arrived.

Francis stood in front of the blueprint:
Nine giant letters, shining white in the sketches.

L O U I E W O O D

Not a copy.
Not a parody.
A **promise**.

More Than Just a Sign

This wasn't about ego.

This was a **symbol of transformation**.
Of what happens when a *nobody with a broken wallet* dares to believe in something the world laughs at.

> "This sign ain't just letters," Francis told them.
> "It's a battle cry. A message from Gingoog to the world, that greatness grows in the most forgotten places."

The Vibe on the Ground

- Construction workers sang local chants while hammering steel.
- Drones flew overhead, documenting the build for the Netflix series now officially greenlit.
- Volunteers carried solar panels up the mountain, the whole thing was gonna be off-grid, eco-powered.
- Kids from nearby barangays painted murals of Francis, Eira, and Annica beside giant cannabis leaves and mountain gods.

Hollywood Takes Notice

A trending tweet from a verified Hollywood director:

> "A man in Mindanao is building something bigger than letters. He's building a legend. #Louiewood 🔥"

Suddenly, articles popped up:

- *"The New Global Cannabis Capital?" - High Times Magazine*
- *"From Cartel to Culture: How Francis Louie Rewrote the Game" - Vice Asia*
- *"Louiewood vs. Hollywood: The Underground Uprising" - Rolling Stone*

Meanwhile, In Gingoog City…

The mayor, who once ignored Francis, tried to claim partial credit.

> "We always believed in Francis…"

Francis just smiled when he saw it on TV.

> "Let them talk," he said. "We move different now."

The Grand Reveal



After three months of sweat, rain, and real-ass work, the day came.

Thousands climbed the hill.
Tourists. Farmers. Students. News crews.
A festival popped off below, local bands, fire dancers, street food, and healing tents with cannabis-infused oils.

At sunset, the lights powered up.

One by one, the letters of **L O U I E W O O D** lit up in the twilight.

And when the final "D" glowed… the mountain **roared**.

People cried.
People hugged.
People *believed.*

Francis Took the Mic One Last Time

No speeches.
No scripts.

Just this:

> "They said we'd never make it.
> We did more than make it…
> We made **history.**
> Welcome to Louiewood, baby."

He lit a fat joint and passed it to a mayor's aide.
Everyone laughed.

Even the wind felt high.

Aftermath

- Tourism spiked.
- A local school started a cannabis science elective.
- Investors from Europe came calling.
- Francis opened his **Cannabis and Culture Academy**, free for youth and returning OFWs.

And from above?

The mountain smiled.

Because Louiewood wasn't just a place.
It was a **mindset.**

Chapter 22: Legacy Mode

"The real ones don't just chase the bag, they build bridges for those still walkin' barefoot."

The **Louiewood** sign still glowed at night.

But now?
It wasn't just lights.
It was a **beacon**.

People from all corners of the Philippines, and even beyond, started making **pilgrimages** to the mountain Francis once bled on.

But what impressed them most wasn't the sign…

It was the **system**.



The Louiewood Blueprint

Inside a bamboo-and-concrete facility near the base of Mt. Balatukan sat with a group of 50 young minds.
Former street vendors. Teenage fathers. Dropouts.
All rocking green hoodies stamped with "GGG" - *Gingoog Green Guild.*

And at the front of the room?

Francis Louie.

Whiteboard. Joint. Vision.

"This ain't about weed no more," he told them.
"It's about wealth. Wisdom. Work.
You're not just here to grow plants.
You're here to grow empires."

Classes Included:

- **Legal Loopholes 101:** How to protect your business in gray areas
- **Hustler Math:** Turning 10K pesos into 100K legally
- **Green Science:** From seed to CBD to sustainability
- **Legacy Planning:** How to feed your great-grandkids with your grind

And once a week?

Special Zoom sessions with global cannabis moguls, now all trying to learn from *Francis Louie of Mindanao.*

The Fathers Return

One rainy Friday, two students showed up to class with their daughters.

Francis just smiled.

"You brought them to the right place, bro.
Let 'em see the roots of their future."

He sat **Eira** and **Annica** down beside the little girls and said:

"These girls? They're the next board of directors."

The Documentary Drops

Titled **"The Grow From Gingoog,"** the Netflix docuseries premiered worldwide.

Footage of:

- Francis dodging cops barefoot through banana fields
- Him breaking down in a shanty, holding a photo of Eira and Annica
- The first meeting with the Dutch scientists
- The first-ever class of the Green Guild

Critics called it *"The Narcos of Hope."*
The streets called it *"The Realest Shit Netflix Ever Dropped."*

The Final Goal: The Louiewood Charter

Francis began drafting something even bigger than the treaty.

The Louiewood Charter
A legal template for nations ready to decriminalize cannabis, written in plain language, with options for:

- Micro-growers
- Community profit-sharing
- Social reintegration programs
- Spiritual protections for indigenous practices

It wasn't just about money anymore.

It was about healing countries…
through the very thing that once got you locked up.

One Last Scene

Francis stands in front of a new building in Gingoog.

All-glass. Five stories. Gold-leaf cannabis designs etched into the walls.

"The Francis Louie Foundation for Freedom."

He lights up, looks out over the city that once slept on him, and says to the camera:

> ***"I'm not immortal. But this?***
> ***This shit right here?***
> ***This gon' live forever."***

He closes the book.

Takes one hit.
Exhales.

And smiles.

Because the truth is… **he made it**.
Not just for himself, but for his **city**, his **family**, his **country**.

Chapter 23: The Stunt That Wasn't Enough

Before the name **LOUIEWOOD** echoed through the mountains…
Before the dreams turned into dirt, concrete, and empire…
There was a stretch of road and a man riding like gravity owed him respect.

Gingoog-Claveria Route 955.
Locals knew it for sharp curves, steep descents, and a silence that dared you to go faster.
But Louie? He turned it into his stage.



No hands on the handlebars.
Body stretched flat across the seat.
Carving corners at speeds that made hearts stop.
No gimmicks. No CGI.
Just muscle, nerve, and control that flirted with madness.

Every ride was a performance.

Every curve, a canvas.
Spectators pulled over to watch.
Vloggers caught it on camera.
The videos went viral.

Millions watched the stunt…
But no one said his name.

They called him:
"Crazy."
"Anonymous."
"The luckiest rider alive."

But not once — **not once** — did the world give Louie the credit he earned.

So he aimed higher.

Guinness World Records.

If the streets wouldn't speak, maybe the world would.

He applied once.
No response.
Twice.
Still nothing.
A third time, all or nothing.

No word. No call. No confirmation.
Not then. Not now. Not ever.

And somewhere in that silence, Louie heard the truth:

"The stunt wasn't enough."

Not for them.

But maybe — just maybe — it wasn't supposed to be.

Maybe he was never meant to go down in record books.
Maybe he was meant to build something **bigger**.

So he left the road behind.
Left the chase.
Left the idea that validation had to come from someone else.

He found a new direction
Not to **impress**, but to **impact**.
Not to go **viral**, but to go **eternal**.

From balancing on roads
to balancing a legacy,
his vision shifted from speed…
to purpose.

And in that shift,
He carved a **monument on a mountain**.

Bigger than any world record.
Bolder than any trick.
Louder than the applause that never came.

> "Some stunts get remembered.
> Others build mountains."

And if you ever find yourself on Route 955, watch the curve.

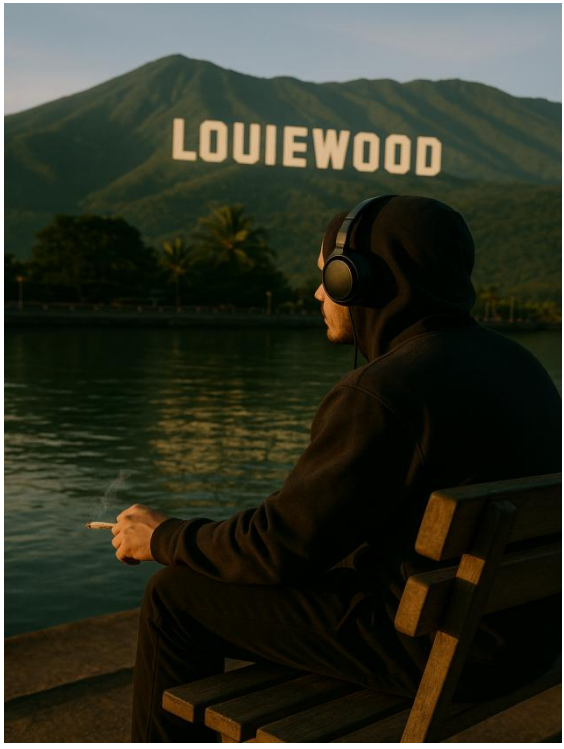
Because somewhere between the bends and the mist,
you might still hear tires humming like a heartbeat,
and feel the ghost of a man who once rode like no one else.

Because Louie didn't just master the road.
He rewrote where it led.

CHAPTER 23: Smoke, Sound & The Sign

He didn't tell anyone he was coming back that day.

No cameras. No entourage. No noise. Just a hooded figure walking through the streets of Gingoog — streets that once knew him as a nobody, now witnessing the quiet return of a king.



He parked his ride a few blocks away and made the walk. No rush. Every step carried the weight of a past only he could carry. The kind of path where concrete remembers your pain and the wind whispers your name.

The pantalan stood still, aged concrete, rusted rails, and the sea, forever licking at the bones of the city. It looked the same. But he had changed.

He sat on the bench where he once dreamed in silence. A younger version of him used to sit there with nothing but ambition in his chest and fire in his gut. That same fire still burned, only now it lit empires.

He lit a joint. Calm. Precise. The flame danced like it recognized what had been built.

In his ears, through a weathered pair of Bluetooth headphones, *"We Built This City" (slowed + reverb)* began to play, no longer just a song, but a personal anthem. A hymn to the nights he almost surrendered, and the mornings he rose anyway.

Then, he looked up.

There it was.

Mt. Balatukan, catching the last of the sun's gold, but it wasn't the mountain alone that took his breath.

It was what stood carved into its soul:

LOUIEWOOD.

White. Massive. Immortal.

Each letter is a victory. Each shadow it cast a chapter of survival.

The birds flew past like they were paying respect. The trees bowed to the wind. The sea seemed to pause in reverence.

He didn't smile for a camera. He didn't pose for praise. He just sat there… and remembered.

Because this wasn't just a monument to success, it was a marker of war. A battle fought in silence, in pain, in fire.

The world had doubted him. Life had bent him. But now, there was no denying what stood on that mountain.

Not just a name. Not just a sign.

A legacy.

He rose from the bench, flicked the last ember of his joint, and walked away slowly — not like a man escaping, but like one arriving.

The matte black Lambo waited, its doors lifting like wings ready to fly.

He stepped in.

Hit play.

And "All the Abov**e** (slowed + reverb)" shook the silence — not just music, but a closing prayer.

The engine roared. The mountain faded into the rearview.

And Louie… disappeared into legend.

"The rest? History."

And if you ever wonder what a dream from the dirt looks like… look up.

It spells LOUIEWOOD.

The Rest Is History.

LOUIEWOOD isn't just a sign. It's a symbol.
Francis Louie isn't just a man. He's a movement.
And Gingoog? It ain't small no more. It's global.

END OF BOOK
Title: *LOUIEWOOD: From Gingoog Dirt to Global Dynasty*
By: Francis Louie Caingles Ramoso

Bunos Chapter: From Gingoog to the Grid: The Rockstar Signal"

Background Track: "No Role Modelz" – J. Cole

There I was — controller in hand, cloud of smoke in the air, half my soul in Gingoog, the other half wandering the streets of Los Santos.

At first? It was just a game. But the deeper I dove in, the more I started seeing signs.

Mount Chiliad? That was Mt. Balatukan with a disguise. Vinewood Sign? Sent chills through my bones — like the word LOUIEWOOD had already been carved in my destiny long before I said it out loud.

They say legends leave clues... Hidden in maps, in mayhem, in music.

And there I was — a nobody from the City of Goodluck, decoding the universe with a secondhand PS3 and a head full of smoke.

Every mission I played, every street I passed in GTA… I wasn't just escaping life. I was scouting the future.

A future where my story — where Gingoog, the forgotten gem — becomes one of the main maps on Earth. Just like how Los Angeles became Los Santos, this place right here? It's about to go worldwide.

So now I'm writing this… Not to dream.

But to signal.

To Rockstar — feel the smoke, G.

Imagine This: The trailer opens...

A slow pan across a mountain. LOUIEWOOD sign blazes through the fog.

Smoke curls through the early morning air like destiny rolling slow.

The camera dives past trees, seawalls, rooftops, and three small fishing boats.

J. Cole's "No Role Modelz" plays — low at first, then thundering in like a heartbeat from the underground.

A voiceover, gritty but calm: "It started with a mountain, a sign… and a dream."

BOOM.

Gingoog becomes legend.

So if you're reading this — Hollywood. Rockstar. Netflix. Red Bull. Guinness. Paramount.

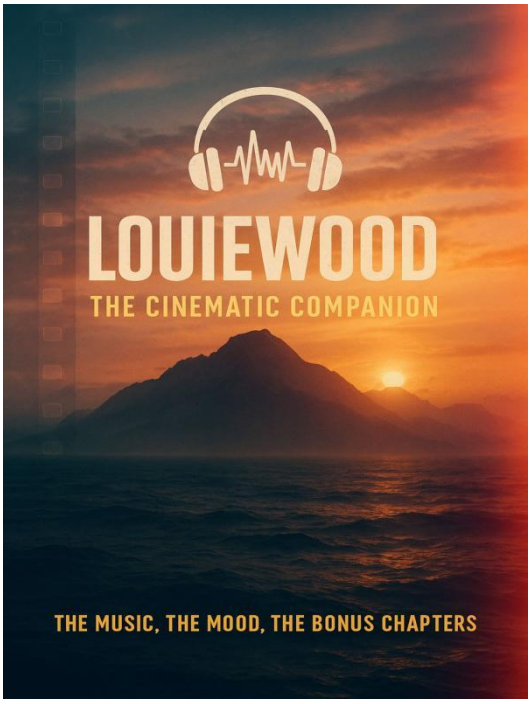
Whoever you are, wherever you at...

This ain't just a book. It's a beacon. It's a blueprint. It's a letter from a city that's ready to rise.

This is how poverty ends. This is how legends begin. This is how a kid with no role models becomes one.

♫ "Don't save her… she don't wanna be saved…"

📍 From Gingoog to the Grid. 📡 We just lit the signal. 🌟
Now let the giants respond.



"Want to feel the cinematic version? Hear the songs, the slow-mo scenes, the heartbeat behind every word? Don't miss ***LOUIEWOOD: The Cinematic Companion.*** *It's not just bonus... it's the blueprint for the big screen*

Acknowledgement

To those who believed — and even more to those who didn't — thank you. Your faith and doubt both fueled this journey.

From the mud of Gingoog to the heights of what the world may someday call "LOUIEWOOD," this book is not just a story — it's proof that dreams built from dirt can touch the skies.

To my family, my children — you are the reason I wake up fighting. To the mothers of my children — we've walked through fire. Whatever tomorrow holds, you are forever part of this legacy.

To everyone who ever said "you're crazy" — maybe I am. Crazy enough to chase the impossible, and stubborn enough to turn it real.

To the people of Mindanao, to the Philippines, and to every underdog across the globe — this book is for you.

And to God, the universe, and the silence that sometimes gave me the loudest answers — I heard You.

This is just the beginning.

— Francis Louie, founder of LOUIEWOOD

About the Author

Francis Louie was born and raised in Gingoog, Misamis Oriental — a city carved between mountain and sea, struggle and dream. With no wealth, no powerful last name, and no map to follow, he built his vision from scratch — dirt-stained hands, sleepless nights, and a belief that the impossible was just the beginning.

A father, a dreamer, and a survivor of the chaos around him, Louie turned pain into purpose and built the idea of LOUIEWOOD — a bold, defiant vision rooted in Filipino pride but reaching out to the world. His mission is bigger than fame or fortune: it's about legacy, redemption, and proving that greatness can rise from the most unexpected places.

This is his first published book — but not the last. LOUIEWOOD is more than a name. It's a movement. A message. A monument to the underdog.

About the Publisher

LOUIEWOOD was not born in a polished corporate boardroom. It was forged in the backrooms of raw vision—hewn directly out of sweat, unyielding struggle, and a stubborn refusal to accept secondary status.

Founded by Francis Louie C. Ramoso, LOUIEWOOD is far more than a publishing imprint. It is an active declaration of sovereign purpose. We exist to anchor and elevate narratives that rise from the ground up, to amplify the voices of the unheard, and to command an ecosystem of thought that dreams completely beyond borders.

Originating from the raw dirt of Gingoog City, Misamis Oriental, Philippines, LOUIEWOOD is intentionally engineered to become a premier global platform for bold, independent minds.

This is the origin. This is the foundation.

This is the first—but it is far from the last.

LOUIEWOOD

Books Built on Structure. Proven by Clarity.

To track the expansion of the dynasty and explore the complete catalog, visit **louiewood.com**.

"This started with nothing but vision, pain, and fire. Now it's legacy."

-Francis Louie

